

Leave Policy

Effective Date:

Policy effective from date - 2 Jan 2026

Disclaimer:

The company reserves the right to alter or withdraw the policy at any point of time.

Introduction:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that the employees follow a work life balance and enable them to manage any personal emergencies that may arise.

The policy ensures that leave is planned and communicated to managers and HR in advance so that work is not affected. Employees must follow the defined procedures and apply for leave through the HRMS portal in a timely manner.

These policies will be reviewed and modified periodically. When using this policy, please remember that while we have attempted to make it as comprehensive as possible, there might arise situations which are not dwelt upon and hence you might need to seek assistance from your supervisor or Human Resources ("HR"). The company reserves the right to modify this policy as per business requirements.

Leave Accounting Year:

The leaves are accounted on the basis of calendar year i.e. January 1st to 31st December.

Scope:

Full-Time Employees: Eligible for all leave types.

Full-Time Contractuals: Eligible for, SL, LWP and EL only.

Interns: Eligible for SL, LWP and (Comp Off optional based on work needs).

Responsibilities:

Direct Managers/Leads are responsible for approving leaves. Leaves should be granted based on the employee's needs, supported by necessary documentation (where applicable), while ensuring that business requirements are appropriately balanced.

HR to incorporate leave related inputs while processing payroll.

Policy Guidelines:

- a. In case of unapproved leave, it will be marked as leave without pay (LWP).
- b. In case of emergency, the employee who could not apply for leaves in advance should inform his/her Direct Manager/Lead about the emergency before 11 AM through mode of email/phone call and follow the process of leave application after resuming office after leave.
- c. Leaves can be taken into blocks of half day and full day as per the available leave balance.
- d. An employee who has taken leave without obtaining prior approval, will be deemed to be absent from work without permission. This may result in disciplinary actions.
- e. An employee who wishes to cancel previously applied and approved leave/WFH must inform their reporting manager and raise a ticket in the HRMS portal for cancellation.
- f. No leave, except maternity leave, can be claimed by an employee as a matter of right. Granting of leave shall be at the discretion of the Company depending on work exigencies. Further, in exigencies, the Company reserves its right to call the employee back to join duty as immediately as possible even if the employee is on any sanctioned leave.
- g. Notwithstanding anything above, if an employee does not report to work due to sudden sickness, he/she would be required to notify his reporting manager before the commencement of normal business hours.
- h. If an employee wishes to avail any leave for which he/she is not entitled, prior approval from the Direct Manager is mandatory before proceeding on leave. An email confirmation of the same must also be shared with HR for record and update. All such leaves will be treated as *Leave Without Pay (LWP)* in the payroll.
- i. Half day would be marked if working hours for a day is less than 6 hrs.
- j. If the green dot is not marked in the timesheet, it will be considered as leave.

Categories Of Leaves:

Leave Type	Count	Total Leaves	Eligible Employees
EARNED LEAVES(EL)	1 Day/Per month	12 Days/Year	Full Time, Full Time Contractual
MATERNITY LEAVES (ML)	180 Days	180 Days/Year	Full Time
PATERNITY LEAVE (PTL)	2 Days	2 Days/Year	Full Time
SICK LEAVES (SL)	5 Days	5 Days/Year	Full Time, Contractual FT, Interns FT
LEAVE WITHOUT PAY (LWP)	As Applicable	As Applicable	ALL
BEREAVEMENT LEAVE	2 Days	2 Days/Year	ALL
COMPENSATORY OFF	As Applicable	As Applicable	Full Time, Interns FT
RESTRICTED HOLIDAYS (RH)	2 Days	2 Days/Year	Full Time
WORK FROM HOME	5 Days	60 Days	Full Time

Note- If an intern/Contract person is converted into full time/permanent employee then on his/her confirmation all his/her previous leaves will be canceled and new leaves will be given according to the joining date.

- **Clubbing with other leaves/ RH/ Holidays**

Earned Leaves can be clubbed with Leave without Pay/ Company Holidays/ Restricted Holidays.

1. Earned Leaves (EL)

a) Eligibility

- All regular full-time employees and Full time contractual employees at Devstringx are eligible for Earned Leaves.
- The leave earned by an employee is the period which he has earned according to company's rules and he will be entitled to leave only after it has been earned.
- Earned Leave is calculated on a month on month basis for each calendar year.
- If you have joined during the middle of the year, your Earned Leave will be pro-rated from the date you start employment through December 31 of that calendar year.
- The manager reserves full authority to cancel approved leave in case of work urgency or any official requirement.

Entitlement

- All full-time employees and full time contractual employees are entitled to Earned Leave from their date of joining on a pro-rata basis. (1 day for each completed month).
- Intervening weekly off days will be counted as part of the leave.

b) Accumulation/ Carry forward / Encashment

- Earned Leave can be carried forward and accumulated up to a maximum of 25 days. EL beyond 25 days shall be encashed.
- Accumulated leaves can be encashed during the time of separation. Earned Leave is encashed on the basic salary of the employee.

c) Adjustment against notice period

- Balance Leaves cannot be adjusted against the notice period during termination of services.
- If, at the time of separation, an employee has availed more Earned Leave than entitled, the excess will be recovered from salary/dues.

d) Earned Leave (EL) balance beyond 25 days will be automatically encashed. No additional ELs will be accrued once the balance reaches 25 days in the following year.

- e).** Any excess EL leaves at the time of exit will be encashed based on your basic salary.

f). If an employee separates or is terminated before completing a quarter, prorated Earned Leave will be credited for encashment up to the resignation date. No EL will accrue beyond the date of resignation.

g). The resigned employee is expected to avail not more than 1 EL during the notice period. The deduction of these LWP will be done with the Payment settlement.

h). EL can be combined with ML/PTL/LWP/Compoff.

2. Maternity Leave (ML)

Eligibility

- All regular full-time women employees who have worked continuously for a period of at least 80 days during 12 months immediately preceding the date of her expected date of delivery, are entitled to receive maternity benefit of a total of 26 weeks of paid leave, whether taken before or after childbirth. However the employee cannot take leaves more than eight weeks before her expected date of delivery.

Process

- In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, an employee on production/submission of the prescribed proof to HR in the form a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner, will be entitled to leave with pay, for a period of 6 weeks immediately following the day of her miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy. Miscarriage means expulsion of contents of uterus at any period prior or during 26th week of pregnancy. This leave can be availed on approval from HR and RM.
- Medical termination of the pregnancy should be one that is advised by the doctor/medical practitioner. Medical termination of the Pregnancy for the purpose of this policy shall mean the termination of pregnancy as permissible under the provisions of Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, 1971. In terms of the applicable provisions of Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, 1971, a pregnancy may be terminated by a registered medical practitioner,
 - a) Where the length of the pregnancy does not exceed twelve weeks.

- b) Where the length of the pregnancy exceeds twelve weeks but does not exceed twenty weeks, if not less than two registered medical practitioners are, of opinion, formed in good faith, that –
 - i.) The continuance of the pregnancy would involve a risk to the life of the pregnant woman or of grave injury to her physical or mental health; or
 - ii.) There is a substantial risk to the child to be born, would suffer from physical or mental abnormalities as to be seriously handicapped.
 - iii.) Where any pregnancy is alleged to have been caused by an unfortunate act, and the same has been presumed to constitute a grave injury to the mental health of the pregnant woman.
- However, the aforesaid benefits will not apply if the termination of pregnancy is voluntary and accordingly leave cannot be claimed under this policy.
- In case of maternity leave, the employee must submit an application/request at least 6 weeks in advance in LMS(Local Maternity System) as has been prescribed under the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 with the expected date of delivery. The employee is required to produce a medical certificate confirming the pregnancy and detailing the expected date of birth and the date on which the maternity leave is to commence. The employee can avail the maternity leave post approval from RM and HR.

3. Sick Leave (SL)

Eligibility

All regular full-time employees/Interns/Full Time Contractuals at Devstringx are eligible for Sick Leave.

Employees may use sick time for the following qualifying reasons:

- a) An employee is entitled to 5 days of Sick Leave in a year which shall be credited to the employee's account at the beginning of the calendar year. New employees are eligible to use Sick Leave immediately upon hire.
- b) If you have joined in the middle of the year, your Sick Leave entitlement will be pro-rated.
- c) Sick Leave cannot be clubbed with Earned Leave.
- d) Sick Leave is inclusive of weekly holidays.

e)The diagnosis, care or treatment of a mental or physical illness, injury or health condition, or need for medical diagnosis of, or preventative care for an employee or employee's family member.

Process

- Sick Leave is to be taken in cases of injury/ illness to the employee. An employee must intimate his/ her manager either over the phone or through email.
- For all absences exceeding 3 days, a medical certificate/or medical documents needs to be enclosed.
- For all absences exceeding 5 days/ entitlement, every additional day beyond the 5th day will be adjusted against Earned Leave in credit of the employee, subject to production of aforesaid medical papers.

4. Paternity Leave (PTL)

Eligibility

- A male employee is eligible for 2 working days of paid paternity leave for the birth of his child(ren). A formal communication along with documentary evidence is to be submitted to the reporting manager.
- This leave can only be availed by Full Time employees.
- This leave can be availed for taking care of Surrogate children as well.
- This leave must be availed within 1 year of the child(ren)'s birth and in continuation.

Please Note: Any weekly off or Company Holiday that falls during Maternity leave will be counted as part of the respective leave period and will not give rise to any additional leave or payment

****In an unfortunate event of the demise of the mother at the time of childbirth, the father will be entitled to take 2 weeks of continuous paid leave to take care of the child.**

5. Bereavement Leave

Eligibility

It is the company's policy to grant paid time off from work to employees for the death of a relative.

Employees are eligible for up to 2 days leave, if necessary, in the event of the death of an immediate family member (defined as parents, grandparents, siblings, spouse, children and in-laws). The company requests that you notify your Supervisor/ HR team, as early as possible, of an intention to take Bereavement Leave.

6. Restricted Holiday (RH)

- All Full time employees are authorized to take 2 RH leaves as per their choice in a year.
- RH Leaves need to be applied at least 3 days in advance otherwise leave will not be considered.

7. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Process

- As far as possible, the employees should avoid LWP.
- If an employee wants to take leave they are not entitled to, prior approval from the Direct Manager is required, and an email must be sent to both the Manager and HR. Such leave will be treated as Leave Without Pay (LWP) in payroll.
- LWP should be taken for a genuine need only.
- Such approval should be obtained prior to going on LWP; otherwise the employee will be treated as absconding from the service.
- LWP is not a matter of right. Sanctioning is at the sole discretion of the company. Absence from work without DIRECT MANAGER's approval is breach of discipline. Disciplinary action, including termination of service, can be initiated.
- Continuation of employment following incidence of LWP will be at the discretion of the management.

8. Encashment Methodology

- Encashment can be done at the end of every calendar year in December.
- Encashment benefit is available at one time the basic salary.
- Encashment benefit is available for all positions across the organization.

9. Leave during notice period

Any type of leave cannot be adjusted against the notice period.

10. Compensatory Off (CO)

If an employee works on a public holiday, he/she can avail comp off till the time comp off stands valid. Similarly, when the employee works on a weekend, if the person has genuinely come to the office to work, the same rule applies. However, in exceptional circumstances if an employee is required to work for less than 5 hours, he / she shall be entitled for half day Comp Off.

Guidelines

- Supervisors can grant a Comp Off to their team after taking an approval from the Department Head. A copy of the approval email should be marked to HR for updating the comp off records if needed.
- Comp Off should be pre-approved by the Supervisors in HRMS else they will be marked as absent from duty and will be treated accordingly.
- Comp Off should be availed within a period of 60 days from the day it is sanctioned.
- Any un-availed Comp Off would lapse automatically after 60 days.
- Comp Off can be clubbed with leaves, holidays and weekly off days.
- Comp Off cannot be encashed.
- Comp off leave balance will be exhausted/lapse if any employee is made permanent from an intern/contractual.
- All Compensatory Off (Comp Off) requests must be submitted through the CloveHR Portal.
- All Compensatory Off (Comp Off) requests must be applied through the **CloveHR Portal** and approved by the respective manager. Any Comp Off not applied or approved in the system will be considered as leave.

Leads/ Managers are required to inform the HR if they or their team is required to come to office on a weekend/ company holiday, at least a day in advance.

11. Weekly Offs & Holidays

Unless required to attend office under special situations, all Saturdays & Sundays will be off except 1st Saturday of the month that too is required only if there is some urgent task pending.

12. National/ Festive Holiday

Employees will be entitled to **9 National/ Festive Holidays** as per list declared in the beginning of the calendar year by the HR Team.

Employees not working in India work shifts will be informed about the leaves applicable to them during the respective project, by the Project Head at least a week in advance.

13. Work from Home (WFH) Policy

Objective

To offer flexibility while maintaining productivity and collaboration, this policy allows eligible employees to avail up to five (5) Work-from-Home (WFH) days per month. These days are intended for occasional remote work and are subject to business requirements.

Policy Overview

- Only Full time employees can avail this benefit.
- Each eligible employee is entitled to 5 WFH days per calendar month.
- Unused WFH days will lapse at the end of each month and cannot be carried forward or encashed.
- WFH requests must be submitted and approved at least 1 working day in advance.
- WFH can be availed only if it's approved by the manager.
- All employees are required to mark their attendance in HRMS on a daily basis. While marking your attendance, please make sure that your work location is specified for the day — whether you are working from home (WFH), working from office (WFO), or at a client site. Additionally, your daily attendance/timesheets must be reviewed and approved by your manager and the HR to ensure accuracy and compliance.
- In HRMS it is mandatory to mark your attendance on a daily basis whether an employee is doing WFH, is on client side work or doing WFO.
- Employees are allowed to avail up to 5 Work From Home (WFH) days per month. If you exceed this limit, any additional WFH days will be considered as leave and will be deducted from your leave balance accordingly.
- As per the company's WFH policy, employees are allowed up to 5 WFH days per month. However, in case of emergency situations, employees may request additional WFH days beyond this limit.

Please note that for any extra WFH days due to emergencies, you must:

- ❖ Provide relevant supporting documents explaining the emergency, and
- ❖ Obtain prior approval from your Manager

3. Usage Guidelines

- Employees must be fully available and responsive during regular work hours while working remotely.
- A stable internet connection and access to necessary tools (VPN, systems, etc.) are the employee's responsibility.
- WFH cannot be split into half-days.
- WFH cannot be clubbed with any form of leave (Sick, Earned, Comp Offs etc.) or used to extend weekends/holidays.
- Managers reserve the right to cancel an approved WFH request at any time due to business needs, client meetings, or team dependencies. In such cases, reasonable notice will be provided where possible.

4. Restrictions

- WFH is not a substitute for leave. If the employee is unable to perform duties (e.g., due to illness), appropriate leave should be applied.
- WFH days cannot be combined with weekends or holidays to create extended breaks.
- This is a privilege, not an entitlement, and is subject to ongoing review and performance standards.

5. Exceptions

- Employees with valid personal or medical reasons may request additional WFH flexibility with proper documentation.
- Extended WFH arrangements may be considered based on project or department-specific needs and must be formally approved.

6. Compliance and Monitoring

- Managers must track WFH usage within their teams to ensure adherence.
- HR/Management can monitor monthly utilization of WFH at any point of time.
- Managers have the discretion to revoke or cancel WFH approvals due to urgent operational needs.
- Any misuse of WFH privileges may result in disciplinary action or revocation of the benefit.

Guidelines

- Upon prior approval of the Reporting Manager, an employee may work from home in case the need arises. Such approvals should be submitted in advance via HRMS portal; else the employee would be marked on leave for that day.
- Employees working from home will commit to clear deliverables with their managers/ supervisors over email, and phone. Also they should remain available for scheduled meetings & calls.
- Employees are required to work for a minimum of 9 hours per day for full day consideration and 5 hours for Half day consideration, calculation would be done on that basis only.
- The employee availing WFH benefit needs to send a compiled report at the end of the day to his/ her reporting manager and HR otherwise no WFH would be considered.
- During the WFH period, the employee cannot undertake full time/ part time employment anywhere in any capacity.
- Increments and promotions are not affected by the WFH option.

14) Procedure for Applying for Leaves

- You are required to apply for leave through HRMS. Click here to apply (<https://clovehr.com/login?url=devstringx>). Non information of leaves will be treated as LWP. Requests for leave shall be considered in the light of current and anticipated workloads. The immediate superior has a discretionary right to sanction, defer or refuse leave as per the exigency of work.
- If an Employee is absent from work for any reason, and that absence has not been previously authorized by his/ her immediate superior, he/ she is responsible to notify the immediate superior as soon as possible.
- In case of such unauthorized absence on the grounds of medical reasons for more than three days, an employee is required to submit a medical certificate on his/ her return to HR.

15. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed every 6 months or as needed. Updates will be communicated to all employees in advance.